RESEARCH REPORT / 2027 OUTLOOK

AEO & GEO Tools Report 2027

A comparative review of six platforms for measuring and improving visibility across AI-powered search and answer experiences.

Platforms reviewed

Citetail • AthenaHQ • Rankscale • Rankability • SE Ranking / SE Visible • Ahrefs Brand Radar

Research snapshot **30 October 2026**	**Purpose** **Independent product comparison and selection guidance**

Prepared as a research-led comparison. Inclusion does not imply endorsement, partnership, testing certification or paid placement.

Executive Summary

AEO (Answer Engine Optimization) and GEO (Generative Engine Optimization) have become practical extensions of search visibility work. The platforms in this review help organizations understand whether brands are mentioned, recommended or cited in AI-generated answers, and in some cases provide workflows to improve the content and authority signals behind those answers.

The six products are not identical categories of software. Some are primarily AI-visibility trackers; others combine AI monitoring with traditional SEO research, content operations, technical audits or broader brand intelligence. Comparing them as if they were interchangeable would obscure important differences.

Key findings

• **Dedicated AI visibility:** Citetail, AthenaHQ, Rankscale and SE Visible place AI answer monitoring at the centre of their positioning.

• **Broader SEO workflows:** Rankability combines traditional SEO research, content creation, auditing, promotion and tracking, including AI answers and citations.

• **Large-scale discovery data:** Ahrefs Brand Radar combines custom prompt tracking with an indexed view of AI visibility and adjacent discovery channels.

• **Coverage is not uniform:** Engines, locations, languages, prompt limits and refresh cadence differ. A high model count alone does not establish better measurement.

• **Measurement requires repeatability:** AI responses vary by prompt wording, location, model version and time. One-off screenshots should not be treated as stable performance evidence.

How to use this report

Use the profiles to create a shortlist, then validate the same prompt set, target markets, engines, cadence and competitor list in each shortlisted product. Confirm plan-level access, data export, API terms and billing before procurement. The report does not declare an overall winner because the right fit depends on workflow and measurement requirements.

Scope note

This is a forward-looking 2027 report based on publicly available vendor documentation reviewed on 30 October 2026. It is not a prediction that every listed feature will remain unchanged throughout 2027. Product availability, pricing, platform integrations and plan entitlements can change.

1. Scope, terminology and methodology

AEO and GEO: working definitions

AEO describes efforts to make information clear, structured and useful enough to be surfaced as a direct answer in answer-oriented interfaces. **GEO** describes efforts to improve the likelihood that generative systems include, describe or cite a brand and its information in generated responses. In practice, the terms overlap and vendors do not always use them consistently.

What these platforms generally measure

Measurement area	What it can indicate	What it does not prove by itself
Brand mentions	Whether a brand appears in sampled answers and how prominently.	That the brand is recommended to every user or drives conversions.
Citations / sources	Which URLs or domains are referenced as sources in sampled answers.	That every citation caused the answer or is a direct ranking factor.
Share of voice	Relative share of mentions within a defined prompt and competitor set.	Market share or total consumer demand.
Sentiment	How sampled responses describe a brand, based on the vendor's method.	A complete or objective measure of public reputation.
Visibility score / position	A vendor-defined summary of presence and placement.	A standardized cross-vendor score; formulas differ.

Evaluation criteria used in this report

• **Product scope:** dedicated AI visibility tool versus broader SEO/content platform.

• **AI surface coverage:** published support for conversational assistants, AI Overviews and AI search experiences.

• **Measurement depth:** mentions, citations, sources, position, sentiment and competitor comparison.

• **Operational workflow:** audits, content recommendations, reporting, integrations and automation.

• **Scale and governance:** projects, prompts, locations, teams, exports, API/MCP and agency workflows where documented.

• **Transparency:** clarity of public documentation, plan restrictions and caveats.

Evidence standard and limitations

The review prioritizes official product pages and vendor help centres. Vendor-stated features are described as vendor-documented capabilities, not independently verified performance. No hands-on benchmark, controlled prompt experiment, customer reference check or security audit was conducted for this report. Where a detail was not clearly documented in the sources reviewed, it is marked as requiring confirmation rather than inferred.

2. At-a-glance comparison

The table summarizes the products' publicly documented emphasis. A check mark means the capability is described in the reviewed documentation; it does not mean all plans include it or that implementations are identical.

Platform	Product orientation	AI visibility / mentions	Citations / sources	Competitor view	Broader workflow
Citetail	Dedicated AEO/GEO visibility and optimization	Yes	Yes	Yes	Domain audit, content guidance, Reddit discovery, alerts
AthenaHQ	AI search visibility and optimization command centre	Yes	Yes	Yes	Content gaps, PR/brand monitoring, executive reporting
Rankscale	Dedicated GEO monitoring and analysis	Yes	Yes	Yes	Page audits, prompt research, API, MCP, Looker Studio
Rankability	SEO/content operations with AI tracking	Yes	Yes	Yes	Research, content creation, audits, promotion, automation
SE Ranking / SE Visible	AI visibility product alongside SEO platform	Yes	Yes	Yes	SEO toolkit, source discovery, API, Data Studio/MCP
Ahrefs Brand Radar	AI visibility index plus custom prompt monitoring	Yes	Yes	Yes	SEO/search demand, web visibility, YouTube/Reddit/TikTok surfaces

Important comparability caveats

• The number of supported AI platforms is not directly comparable unless the same query mode, region, language, personalization state and collection method are used.

• Some tools provide indexed or modeled datasets; others query live or browser-rendered interfaces on a schedule. These approaches answer different research questions.

• A platform may expose a feature in its product documentation while restricting it by plan, add-on, region or usage allowance.

• Traditional SEO capabilities can complement AEO/GEO work, but keyword rankings and backlinks are not substitutes for measuring AI answers and citations.

3. Platform profile: Citetail

Citetail positions itself as an AEO/GEO and AI-visibility platform. Its public product page describes a workflow spanning domain analysis, AI visibility scoring, citation tracking, Reddit thread discovery, content optimization, competitor benchmarking, sentiment analysis and PR tracking.

Documented capabilities

• Published AI surfaces include ChatGPT, Perplexity, Gemini, Claude, Copilot and Google AI Overviews in its feature descriptions. The page also references six or more engines in plan information.

• The platform describes daily citation checks on selected queries and page-level attribution, alongside weekly updates for its rolled-up AI visibility score.

• Its product page describes crawlability, schema and structured-data auditing; page-level content recommendations; competitor comparisons; and alerts through Slack or email.

• A Reddit Finder is positioned to identify relevant threads and whether the brand appears in them. An AI agent is described as able to rewrite or patch selected content issues.

Research assessment

Citetail's product positioning is relatively broad for a dedicated visibility product, combining measurement with recommended fixes. Teams evaluating it should test how its overall score is calculated, how query samples are selected, and whether each claimed engine and workflow is available in the intended subscription.

Commercial and access considerations

The public page lists Starter, Growth, Pro and Business tiers, with published starting prices of US$49, US$99 and US$199 per month for the first three tiers at the time reviewed. Pricing, query limits and feature access should be reconfirmed directly before purchase.

Primary source: https://www.citetail.com/

4. Platform profile: AthenaHQ

AthenaHQ describes itself as an AI search visibility platform designed to help brands monitor and improve their presence across major AI answer experiences. Its public documentation emphasizes a unified command centre for SEO, content, PR, brand and leadership teams.

Documented capabilities

• Vendor documentation lists ChatGPT, Perplexity, Google AI Overviews, Google AI Mode, Gemini, Claude, Copilot and Grok, with additional models available on request.

• Documented capabilities include brand mention tracking, competitor monitoring, share-of-voice comparisons, citation-source analysis and sentiment monitoring.

• Content-oriented features include AI-query content gap analysis, optimization recommendations and AI-friendly content templates.

• The vendor also describes PR monitoring, mention alerts, crisis detection and executive reporting with ROI-oriented analytics.

Research assessment

AthenaHQ's stated scope extends beyond rank-style monitoring into brand and content workflows. Buyers should validate which models are enabled by default, how often each is queried, how citations are attributed and what level of historical data is retained.

Commercial and access considerations

Public feature documentation reviewed did not provide a sufficiently clear, directly comparable price schedule for this report. Request a written quote that specifies prompt volume, engine access, refresh cadence, seats, history, exports and overage terms.

Primary source: https://athenahq.ai/

5. Platform profile: Rankscale

Rankscale is positioned as a GEO monitoring and analysis product. Its documentation describes measuring how a brand, website, product or service appears in AI answers, then analyzing the sources and sentiment associated with those answers.

Documented capabilities

• Its public materials identify ChatGPT, Google AI Overviews, Perplexity, Claude, Gemini and DeepSeek among supported AI search experiences; the pricing page also lists additional engines and modes.

• Core analytical views include visibility, mentions, citations, sentiment and position, with competitor comparisons across tracked prompts.

• The platform describes website audits, prompt research and query fan-out analysis to identify related searches AI systems may use when preparing answers.

• Integration and data access options include a REST API, MCP server and Looker Studio reporting.

Research assessment

Rankscale offers a relatively measurement-focused workflow with useful reporting and data-access options. Buyers should examine the credit model carefully: query costs vary by engine and tracking cadence, and broad coverage can materially change monthly usage.

Commercial and access considerations

The pricing page reviewed lists public monthly plans including Pro at US$99, Pro+ at US$229, Growth at US$385 and Enterprise at US$780, with usage credits and answer-volume limits. Confirm billing currency, annual discounts, add-ons and current engine multipliers.

Primary source: https://rankscale.ai/

6. Platform profile: Rankability

Rankability is broader than a dedicated GEO tracker. Its help centre describes an SEO and AI-search workspace for agencies, consultants and in-house teams, bringing client management, research, content creation, auditing, promotion, tracking, automation and reporting into one application.

Documented capabilities

• The official tracking documentation lists AI Overview, AI Mode, ChatGPT, Perplexity, Gemini, Claude, Grok, Copilot, Brave AI, DeepSeek and Meta AI as supported AI answer platforms.

• Depending on subscription, core access differs: the documentation lists ChatGPT, Google AI Mode and Claude in Core; additional platforms in Team; and all currently supported AI platforms in Agency.

• AI answer checks can capture answer text, brand mentions, citations and available sentiment evidence. The product also supports traditional, local and video search tracking.

• Its wider workflow includes keyword research, content briefs and drafts, site and page audits, backlink prospecting, client workspaces and scheduled automation.

Research assessment

Rankability may be a stronger fit for teams that want AI tracking inside a broader SEO and content-production workflow. Its breadth introduces configuration complexity: buyers should review plan entitlements, platform multipliers, scan cadence and pooled usage before setting up recurring client reports.

Commercial and access considerations

The reviewed official documentation did not establish a simple public price comparison suitable for this report. Confirm plan-specific AI engine access, usage limits, client seats, reporting and add-on costs with the vendor.

Primary source: https://www.rankability.com/

7. Platform profile: SE Ranking / SE Visible

SE Ranking has expanded its AI search offering through SE Visible, a standalone AI visibility product, alongside AI Search functionality within its broader SEO ecosystem. SE Visible focuses on how a brand appears in AI answers; SE Ranking supports wider SEO research and optimization.

Documented capabilities

• SE Visible documentation lists ChatGPT, Google AI Overviews, Google AI Mode and Gemini. Its FAQ describes coverage across 42 countries and daily refresh by default.

• Reported measures include visibility, share of voice, average position, net sentiment, brand mentions and separately tracked cited sources.

• The platform identifies domains and URLs appearing in AI answers, and supports competitor comparisons, topic and prompt filters, CSV export, API and MCP/Data Studio connectivity.

• SE Ranking's help centre notes a product transition: customers who subscribed before 29 October 2026 may retain the legacy AI Results Tracker; newer customers use SE Visible for AI visibility.

Research assessment

SE Visible is notable for documented geographic coverage, daily checks and explicit separation between mention-based visibility and citations. The product currently lists four AI systems in its FAQ, so teams requiring broader assistant coverage should verify roadmap and availability before selection.

Commercial and access considerations

The SE Visible pricing page reviewed lists Basic at US$71/month, Core at US$151/month and Agency at US$319/month on the displayed promotional pricing, with higher list prices also shown. Enterprise is custom. Verify billing term, region, currency and current price.

Primary source: https://visible.seranking.com/

8. Platform profile: Ahrefs Brand Radar

Ahrefs Brand Radar combines an AI visibility index with custom prompt tracking. It is designed both for broad discovery across a large indexed prompt set and for monitoring selected buyer questions over time.

Documented capabilities

• Ahrefs' help documentation describes an index of hundreds of millions of search-backed prompts, with brand, product, region and author research.

• Its AI coverage documentation includes Google AI Overviews and AI Mode, ChatGPT, Perplexity, Gemini, Copilot and Claude for custom prompts; Grok availability is described as temporarily limited in the reviewed help article.

• Custom prompts allow users to track selected questions at daily, weekly or monthly intervals and inspect answers, mentions and cited pages.

• The wider product connects AI visibility with search demand, web visibility and emerging YouTube, Reddit and TikTok visibility datasets.

Research assessment

Brand Radar is differentiated by the combination of a large indexed dataset and user-defined prompt tracking. It can be useful for market discovery and brand benchmarking, while custom prompts support more controlled monitoring. Buyers should distinguish index-based exploration from repeated tracking of a fixed prompt set.

Commercial and access considerations

Ahrefs publishes separate access and add-on structures for AI indexes and custom prompt checks. The help article reviewed lists individual AI index access and an all-platform option, as well as custom prompt tiers. Confirm the current plan requirements and total cost for the exact engine mix.

Primary source: https://ahrefs.com/brand-radar

9. Choosing a platform by requirement

There is no universal best tool across all six products. A selection decision should begin with the team's operating model and the questions it needs to answer.

Requirement	Platforms to evaluate first	Reason to shortlist
Dedicated AI visibility monitoring	Citetail, AthenaHQ, Rankscale, SE Visible	Their public positioning centres on AI answers, brand mentions and citations.
Content and SEO workflow in one workspace	Rankability; SE Ranking ecosystem	Combines AI tracking with wider SEO research, audits or content workflows.
Large-scale prompt discovery and brand research	Ahrefs Brand Radar	Indexed prompt data complements custom prompt monitoring.
Agency/client reporting	Rankability, Rankscale, SE Visible, AthenaHQ	Public materials describe client workspaces, dashboards, exports or executive reporting; validate actual plan limits.
Source and citation intelligence	Citetail, Rankscale, SE Visible, Ahrefs Brand Radar, AthenaHQ	Each documents some form of cited-source or citation analysis; depth and definitions differ.

A practical evaluation checklist

• Can the product track the exact AI engines and surfaces relevant to your customers?

• Can you control prompt wording, language, country, city and refresh cadence?

• Does it store the full answer and source URLs, not only a summary score?

• Can you separate mentions, citations, recommendations, position and sentiment?

• Can it compare the same competitor set across the same prompts and dates?

• Are missing answers, failed scans and untracked engines clearly distinguished?

• Can you export raw results or access them through an API?

• Are prompt limits, engine multipliers, historical retention and overage fees transparent?

• Can you reproduce a sample report and audit how its metrics are calculated?

Suggested pilot design

Run a 30-day pilot using a shared set of 25–50 non-branded buyer prompts, 3–5 competitors, the same target country and language, and a consistent weekly or daily schedule. Keep the prompt set stable during the test. Record the exact engine, date, location, answer text, brand mentions, cited URLs and scan status. Review changes over multiple observations rather than judging a product from a single snapshot.

10. 2027 outlook: what buyers should monitor

The following are evaluation themes, not guaranteed product developments or quantified market forecasts.

1. Measurement quality will matter more than headline scores

As vendors publish more visibility scores, buyers will need transparent formulas, raw-answer access and clear handling of missing results. Cross-tool scores should not be compared unless their sampling and weighting methods are aligned.

2. AI answer surfaces will remain fragmented

Search experiences may combine generated summaries, conversational assistants, citations, shopping results and conventional links. A tool's coverage should be assessed by the exact interface and answer mode it measures, not only by the model brand name.

3. Location and language will be important dimensions

The same prompt can produce different brands and sources across markets. Organizations operating internationally should test localized prompts and verify whether location settings are available for every tracked engine.

4. Citation analysis should connect to content and reputation work

Knowing which sources are cited is useful only when teams can interpret why those sources appear and decide what to improve. Reviews, independent publications, forums, original research and technical accessibility may all be relevant, depending on the topic and engine.

5. AI visibility should be linked to business outcomes

Mentions and citations are intermediate indicators. Where possible, connect AI referral sessions, assisted conversions, qualified leads and revenue to the same reporting period. Avoid treating an increase in AI mentions as proof of incremental business impact.

6. Governance and auditability will become procurement criteria

Teams should ask how vendors collect answers, whether logged-in or personalized states are involved, how data is stored, what is retained, and how model or interface changes are handled. Security and privacy claims should be checked against current documentation and contractual terms.

Overall conclusion

The six platforms represent different approaches to an emerging measurement category. Citetail, AthenaHQ, Rankscale and SE Visible emphasize dedicated AI visibility workflows; Rankability integrates AI tracking into a broader SEO and content operating system; Ahrefs Brand Radar combines large-scale discovery with custom prompt monitoring. The most defensible choice is the one that provides relevant coverage, reproducible evidence, transparent usage economics and a workflow the team will consistently use.

11. Sources and research notes

Primary vendor documentation reviewed on 30 October 2026. The sources below support the product descriptions and feature summaries in this report. Product claims remain attributable to the respective vendors.

1. Citetail — Product overview, features and pricing
https://www.citetail.com/

2. AthenaHQ — Official platform feature documentation
https://answers.athenahq.ai/athenahq-official-ai-search-visibility-platform-features

3. Rankscale — About and platform overview
https://rankscale.ai/about

4. Rankscale — Pricing and plan limits
https://rankscale.ai/pricing

5. Rankscale — Citation analysis documentation
https://help.rankscale.ai/articles/3980938915

6. Rankability — Product overview and workflow
https://help.rankability.com/getting-started/what-is-rankability

7. Rankability — Supported tracking platforms and plan coverage
https://help.rankability.com/track/supported-tracking-platforms

8. SE Visible — Product overview and coverage
https://visible.seranking.com/

9. SE Visible — FAQ, supported engines and measurement notes
https://help.seranking.com/hc/en-us/articles/22266372506524-SE-Visible-FAQ

10. SE Visible — Pricing
https://visible.seranking.com/pricing/

11. SE Ranking — AI Results Tracker transition note
https://help.seranking.com/hc/en-us/articles/16335384225948-What-is-the-AI-Results-Tracker

12. Ahrefs Brand Radar — Product overview
https://ahrefs.com/brand-radar

13. Ahrefs — Brand Radar methodology, coverage and pricing notes
https://help.ahrefs.com/en/articles/11064852-what-is-brand-radar-and-how-to-use-it

Methodological disclaimer

This report is a desk-based comparison of public vendor materials. It does not constitute an endorsement, certification, investment recommendation or guarantee of product performance. No vendor was contacted for comment unless stated otherwise; no paid placements were accepted; no independent product testing was performed. Features, pricing, coverage and availability may change after the research date. Readers should confirm all material details directly with vendors before making procurement decisions.

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